MISSIONS STRATEGY

Engagement Strategy Plan

A short plan for engaging a specific people or place.

NAME

LAST REVISED

HOW TO USE IT

Start small
Blanks are fine. A "don't know yet" is better than a guess.

Write in pencil
Plans change as you meet people, so you'll need to erase.

Revisit often
After your interactions, review this and update what you learned.

Focus statement

One sentence that names who you are trying to reach, where, and what you are praying God will do.

I am seeking to engage _____

in _____

so that _____

_____

Example: Telugu-speaking families in the apartments off Main Street, so that we can develop connections for gospel ministry.

Who's on your team?

Others in your church or beyond who are helping carry out this strategy.

Name	Church/ Organization	How they are helping

Who's praying for you?

Prayer and abiding in Christ sit at the center of the whole task. Who is praying with you, and for what?

Who is praying	How often	Specific requests for this people or place

Adapted from International Mission Board, *Foundations* (2022), and Keelan Cook, *Peoples Next Door: Strategy Overview* (2017).

Profile: what I know and what I don't

Learn these through relationships and conversation. The right-hand column becomes your list of questions to ask next.

Ask about	What I know so far	What I still need to learn
Origin and language Country, region, home language		
Daily life Where they live, work, shop, play		
Gatekeepers Who people trust; who opens the door		
Food and family What they eat; who lives together		
Festivals and finances Holidays that matter; kinds of work		
Faith Religion, practice, spiritual questions		
Existing witness Believers or churches among them		

Gathering places

Places where this community regularly gathers. Several close together often mark the heart of a community. Keep a simple map alongside this list.

Place	What happens there	Gatekeeper or contact

MAP LINK OR LOCATION

Adapted from International Mission Board, *Foundations* (2022), and Keelan Cook, *Peoples Next Door: Strategy Overview* (2017).

Plan across the Missionary Task

Write one or two concrete actions for each component. The components overlap, so revisit all six as you go.

Entry

How will I keep learning the place, the culture and the language?

HOW OFTEN / BY WHEN

Evangelism

How and where will I share the gospel?

HOW OFTEN / BY WHEN

Discipleship

Who could I read Scripture with? What will I model?

HOW OFTEN / BY WHEN

Healthy Church Formation

What are the steps to new churches forming?

HOW OFTEN / BY WHEN

Leadership Development

Who shows influence, spiritual hunger, and maturity?

HOW OFTEN / BY WHEN

Exit to Partnership

Who carries this forward, and how will we keep partnering?

HOW OFTEN / BY WHEN

At the center of all six: prayer and abiding in Christ

Adapted from International Mission Board, *Foundations* (2022), and Keelan Cook, *Peoples Next Door: Strategy Overview* (2017).

Gospel bridges

What in this group's stories, values, or questions open a door to the gospel? Which Bible stories or passages are good places to start?

Church partners

This work belongs to a local church. Who from your church is involved, and in what role?

Role	Names
Advocates Cast vision and rally prayer and support	
Architects Organize what you learn: notes, maps, data	
Engagers Go with you into the community	

Signs of progress

Track what you can do faithfully. Pray for, and celebrate, what only God can do.

What I will count	Target	So far

Revision log

Date	What changed	Why

Adapted from International Mission Board, *Foundations* (2022), and Keelan Cook, *Peoples Next Door: Strategy Overview* (2017).